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Salted Chocolate Chunk Cookies

From Ashley Rodriguez's [Not Without Salt](#) (site) and [Date Night In](#) (book)

A couple recipe-specific notes: The version I originally made from the [Not Without Salt site](#) called for light brown sugar, says you can bake the dough right away and calls for 8 ounces of chocolate. The version in the (excellent) [Date Night In book](#) calls for dark brown sugar, says the dough is best after resting in the fridge for a day or two, and calls for only 6 ounces of chocolate. The good news: both versions work perfectly, but I must insist you use the full half-pound (8 ounces) of chocolate. You will not regret it. In both versions, like most baking recipes, the dry ingredients (salt, flour, baking soda) are to be mixed separately but I'm a lazy cook, and include my own hack below to skip this. Finally, yes, that's 360, not 350 degrees as the baking temperature. Rodriguez says the extra 10 degrees makes for a better cookie, and I'm not one to argue with such clear mastery of the chocolate chip cookie arts.

So what makes this cookie different? Being me, the second I took the first spectacular bite of the cookie, I lined the recipe up to the [Toll House classic](#) because I needed the language to be able to explain what was different. And I found that for the same amount of butter, Toll House cookies use much less sugar, much less flour, a bit less baking soda, less salt and less chocolate. I reiterated this my husband, who I like to torment with boring recipe babble as often as possible, and he — proving once again that he always listens, swoon — said “wouldn't that just mean that there's more cookie batter?” Duh, RIGHT. In fact, you could flip what I said to note that this uses a little *less* butter and egg than the cookies you may be used to and the result is a worrisomely crumbly dough — “The dough exists only to hold the chocolate in place,” says Rodriguez — that bakes up like a freaking dream, mostly because it barely encapsulates almost unseemly-sized puddles of melted chocolate and the whole thing is finished with flakes of sea salt, as all chocolate chip cookies on this earth should forever be.

I swear, I took almost an entire breath while typing that last sentence. (I'm lying. I took a bite of cookie instead.)

Yield: Approximately 18 to 24 cookies

1/2 cup (4 ounces or 113 grams) unsalted butter, at room temperature
2 tablespoons (25 grams) granulated sugar — *keep at 2 even if doubled*
~~2 tablespoons (25 grams) turbinado sugar~~ (aka Sugar in the Raw; you can use more brown or white if you don't have this, but the subtle crunch it adds is delightful)
3/4 cup plus 2 tablespoons (165 grams) packed light or dark brown sugar
1 large egg
1 teaspoon vanilla extract
3/4 teaspoon baking soda
Heaped 1/4 teaspoon (or, technically, 1/4 + 1/8 teaspoon) fine sea or table salt
1 3/4 cups (220 grams) all-purpose flour
~~1/2 pound (225 grams) semi- or bittersweet chocolate~~ *chips* cut into roughly 1/2-inch chunks
with a serrated knife
Flaky sea salt, to finish
1 1/2 cup bittersweet choc chips

Heat oven to 360°F (180°C) and line a baking sheet with parchment paper or a silicon baking mat.

**double recipe*
freeze 1 batch*

*1. 8.17
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did not like
the crunch*

1 cup - 1 1/2 cups

*x 2 = 3 1/2 cups flour
(1 1/2 whole wheat)
(2 cups white)*

In a large bowl, cream the butter and sugars together with an electric mixer until very light and fluffy, about 5 minutes. Add egg and vanilla, beating until incorporated, and scraping down the bowl as needed. Beat in salt fine sea or table salt and baking soda until combined, then the flour on a low speed until just mixed. The dough will look crumbly at this point. With a spatula, fold/stir in the chocolate chunks.

Scoop cookies into 1 1/2 tablespoon (I used a [#40 scoop](#)) mounds, spacing them apart on the prepared baking sheet. Sprinkle each with a few flakes of sea salt. Bake for 11 to 12 minutes, until golden on the outside but still very gooey and soft inside. Out of the oven, let rest on baking sheet out of the for 5 minutes before transferring a cooling rack.

Extra dough — I know, what's that?! — can be formed into scoops and frozen on a sheet until solid, then transferred to a freezer bag. I've baked these right from the freezer; they need, at most, 1 minute more baking time. You could also form them into a 2-inch log, freeze it, and slice and bake the cookies off as desired. The only difference I've noted between the cookies baked right away and those baked a day or more later is that the older cookie dough is less puffy when baked.